Module 1
Introduction to Seeing Through Photographs

- ✓ Welcome to Seeing Through Photographs!
  Reading • 3 min
- ✓ Getting Started: How Does This Course Work?
  Reading • 6 min
- ✓ Seeing Through Photographs Course Trailer
  Video • 1 min
- ✓ Sarah Meister Introduces the Course
  Video • 2 min
- ✓ Marvin Heiferman on "Photography Changes Everything"
  Video • 3 min
- ✓ Optional Discussion Forum Prompts
  Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Optional Readings and Resources
  Reading • 10 min

Module 2
One Subject, Many Perspectives

Part I: Introduction

- ✓ Introduction to Module 1
  Reading • 2 min
- ✓ Artistic Equivalents
  Reading • 2 min
- ✓ Vik Muniz on Photographing the Familiar
  Video • 3 min

Part II: Telescopes and Cameras

- ✓ Introduction to Part II: Surface, Scale, and Technology
  Video • 2 min
- ✓ Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- ✓ Moons and Surfaces
  Reading • 5 min
- ✓ Hear More: Sarah Meister on Eugène Atget. Pendant l'éclipse. 1912
  Video • 3 min
- ✓ Hear More: Liz Deschenes on Tilt/Swing (360° field of vision, version 1), 2009
  Video • 1 min
- ✓ Surface, Scale, Technology
  Dialogue • 15 min

Part III: Seeing the Unseen

- ✓ Introduction to Part III: Man on the Moon
  Video • 2 min
- ✓ Photographs by NASA
  Reading • 2 min
- ✓ Hear More: Sarah Meister on U.S.G.S. and NASA, Surveyor III. Surface of the Moon, Day 319, W-F. 1967
  Video • 1 min
- ✓ Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- ✓ Who Does the Moon Belong To?
  Reading • 4 min

Part IV: It's Only a Paper Moon

- ✓ Introduction to Part IV: Vernacular and Fine Art Photographs of the Moon
  Video • 3 min
- ○ **Moon Phases**
  Reading • 6 min
- ○ Hear More: Sarah Meister on Ansel Adams. Moonrise, Hernandez, New Mexico. 1941
  Video • 3 min
- ○ Man on the Moon and Paper Moons
  Dialogue • 15 min

Part V: Review and Respond

- ○ Optional Readings and Resources
  Reading • 10 min
- ○ Practice Memory Check
  Practice Assignment • 30 min
- ○ Optional Discussion Prompts and Creative Challenges
  Reading • 10 min

Module 3
Documents and the Documentary

Module 4
One and Another

Module 5
Constructing Narratives, Challenging Histories

Module 6
Pictures of People

Module 7
Ocean of Images

Moon Phases

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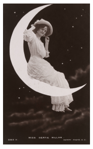
Unknown photographer

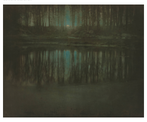


3888 H.
MISS GERTIE MILLAR.

Unknown photographer. *Miss Gertie Millar*. c. 1905. Gelatin silver print, 5 3/8 × 3 5/16" (13.7 × 8.4 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Gift of Peter J. Cohen

This photo postcard showing a woman posing on a paper moon was made at a commercial studio and represents a popular and playful use of the medium. During the early twentieth century, postcards like this were widely collected and shared by people across the world. To meet the demand for these images, commercial studios at carnivals, state fairs, boardwalks, and amusement parks created a variety of whimsical backdrops featuring the moon.

Edward Steichen

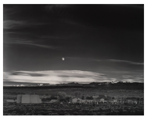


Edward Steichen. *Moonrise–Mamaroneck, New York*. 1904. Platinum and ferroprussiate print, 15 1/4 × 19" (38.7 × 48.2 cm). Gift of the photographer. © 2020 The Estate of Edward Steichen/Artists Rights Society (ARS), New York

Edward Steichen's photograph of the moon rising over a reflective pond suggests the moon's beauty and mystery, the silvery quality of its light, and its illusory proximity to the Earth. He and his Pictorialist peers, including Alfred Stieglitz, sought to distance their work from pictures taken by amateurs and commercial photographers by making prints that looked more like drawings or paintings. He used elaborate darkroom techniques and many layers of chemical processes to achieve these colors, and while enhancing the reeds and grasses in the foreground by hand.

Pursuing the artistic potential of photography meant rejecting its practical functions in the modern industrialized world, and celebrating the purity of nature. Pure as it was, however, the nature that he photographed was rarely wild. Mamaroneck was already a suburb of New York City, where Steichen often ventured to escape from the bustle of city life.

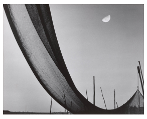
Ansel Adams



Ansel Adams. *Moonrise, Hernandez, New Mexico*. 1941. Gelatin silver print, 15 × 18 1/2" (38.1 × 47 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Gift of the photographer. © 2020 The Ansel Adams Publishing Rights Trust

Ansel Adams was deeply interested in registering the ways that the various stages of the photographic process could be controlled by the photographer—from the exposure of the negative to its development in the darkroom. This print is one of the first of many that he made from a single negative. Attempting to convey the intensity of his experience watching the moon rise over this austere landscape, Adams progressively increased the contrast in the prints, heightening the moon's whiteness and deepening the sky's darkness.

Suirei Kubota

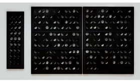


Suirei Kubota. *After Haul*. c.1958. Gelatin silver print, 10 3/4 × 13 3/4" (27.3 × 34.9 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Gift of Nihon Keizai Shimbun. © 2020 Suirei Kubota

This work by Japanese photographer Suirei Kubota was acquired by MoMA in 1959 as part of a large gift of photographs from Nihon Keizai Shimbun, a popular and well-respected Japanese newspaper. Edward Steichen, who was the director of the museum's photography department at the time, described the gift of photographs as "the most important contribution by a single country in recent years." Though not imitative of traditional Japanese art forms, he says there is "a similar regard for subtle balance, delicate mood and fine craftsmanship."

In this photograph, a dark swath of delicate netting sweeps diagonally between two corners of the image. The black of the cloth contrasts with the grey of the sky, gently framing the waxing moon. Kubota's photograph illustrates our fascination with the moon, especially as it existed in the late 1950s when the Space Race had just begun. The fact that this image was circulated through newspapers further speaks to the ways images of the moon were made accessible to the general public.

Leandro Katz



Leandro Katz. Left: *Lunar Alphabet II*. 1978–79. Gelatin silver prints, 96 5/8 × 29 3/16" (245.5 × 74.2 cm). Right: *Lunar Sentence II*. 1978–79. Gelatin silver prints on six panels, overall 111 1/2 × 167" (283.2 × 424.2 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Latin American and Caribbean Fund. © 2020 Leandro Katz

Interested in the concept of language and how it is represented, using film and photography Leandro Katz "collected twenty-seven transitions of the moon taken during many nights until the right shape of the crescent moon was perfect for a particular character of the alphabet." *Lunar Alphabet II* (the panel on the left) holds the key to deciphering the sentence in the six panels on the right, which states: "When we pulverize words, what is left is neither mere noise nor arbitrary, pure elements, but still other words, reflection of an invisible and yet indelible representation: this is the myth in which we now transcribe the most obscure and real power of language." Through this work, Katz not only repurposes an object of our fascination, but also refers to the many ways in which people have tried to ascribe meaning to the moon.

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